

4A modals for rules and advice

REFERENCE

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We can use modals to talk about rules and to give advice.

have to/need to/must

We use *have to/need to/must* when we talk about rules and things that are necessary. You have no choice, or it's a very strong suggestion.

You must talk to your manager about the problem.

We have to pay tax on the money we earn.

I need to get up early to catch my flight tomorrow.

In the positive form we often use *have to, need to* and *must* with the same meaning.

In the negative form, *don't have to/needn't* (or *don't need to*) and *mustn't* have different meanings. We use *don't have to, needn't* and *don't need to* when something is not necessary, but you can do it if you want.

You don't have to finish that report today. Tomorrow will be fine.

You needn't worry too much about that.

You don't need to bring a laptop.

We use *mustn't* when something is not allowed.

You mustn't use your mobile phone when you're on the plane. (It is not allowed and it's dangerous.)

We use *must* to talk about present or future situations. For past situations, we use *had to*.

We must leave soon, before it gets dark. (present/future)

We had to leave early yesterday morning. (past)

should/shouldn't

We use *should/shouldn't* when we are giving advice. We use *should* to talk about things that are a good idea, and *shouldn't* to talk about things that are not a good idea.

You should come to work in smart clothes.

You shouldn't arrive late to meetings.

Should I wear a tie?

Notice that *must* and *should* are followed by the infinitive without *to*.

We must get there on time.

NOT ~~We must to get there on time.~~

You should ask Helen for some advice.

NOT ~~You should to ask Helen for some advice.~~

PRACTICE

1 Match the sentence halves.

- 1 I really look forward to the weekend because I
 - 2 I must try
 - 3 You don't
 - 4 I really think Clarissa should
 - 5 You mustn't give
 - 6 You don't have
 - 7 Can I call you later? I need to
 - 8 Should we
- a need to wait for me, I'll see you later.
 - b to put on your webcam if you don't want to.
 - c don't have to get up early for work.
 - d ask for a pay rise. She deserves it.
 - e wait until everyone arrives?
 - f to visit Frank while he is in hospital.
 - g ask you a few questions.
 - h your phone number to any of the clients.

2 Choose the correct word(s) to complete the text.

5 Steps for fitness success

- Make sure you get some exercise every day. You ¹**don't have to / need to** go running if that's not your style, but you ²**should / don't have** try to do at least an hour of moderate exercise.
- You ³**should to / need to** eat healthily. You ⁴**mustn't / should** try to plan your meals so that you don't get too hungry. You ⁵**mustn't / don't have to** eat lots of sweet snacks. Try eating fruit or vegetables instead.
- Keep track of how many calories you eat. You ⁶**shouldn't / have to** eat more calories than you will use in the day.
- Make sure you get enough sleep. You ⁷**don't need to / should** go to bed early every day, but most of us need six to eight hours of sleep a night.
- Try to stay motivated. If you want to make changes in your life, you ⁸**must / don't have to** stay positive.

